

The Cheese Grater

The Other Student Magazine of University College London Union

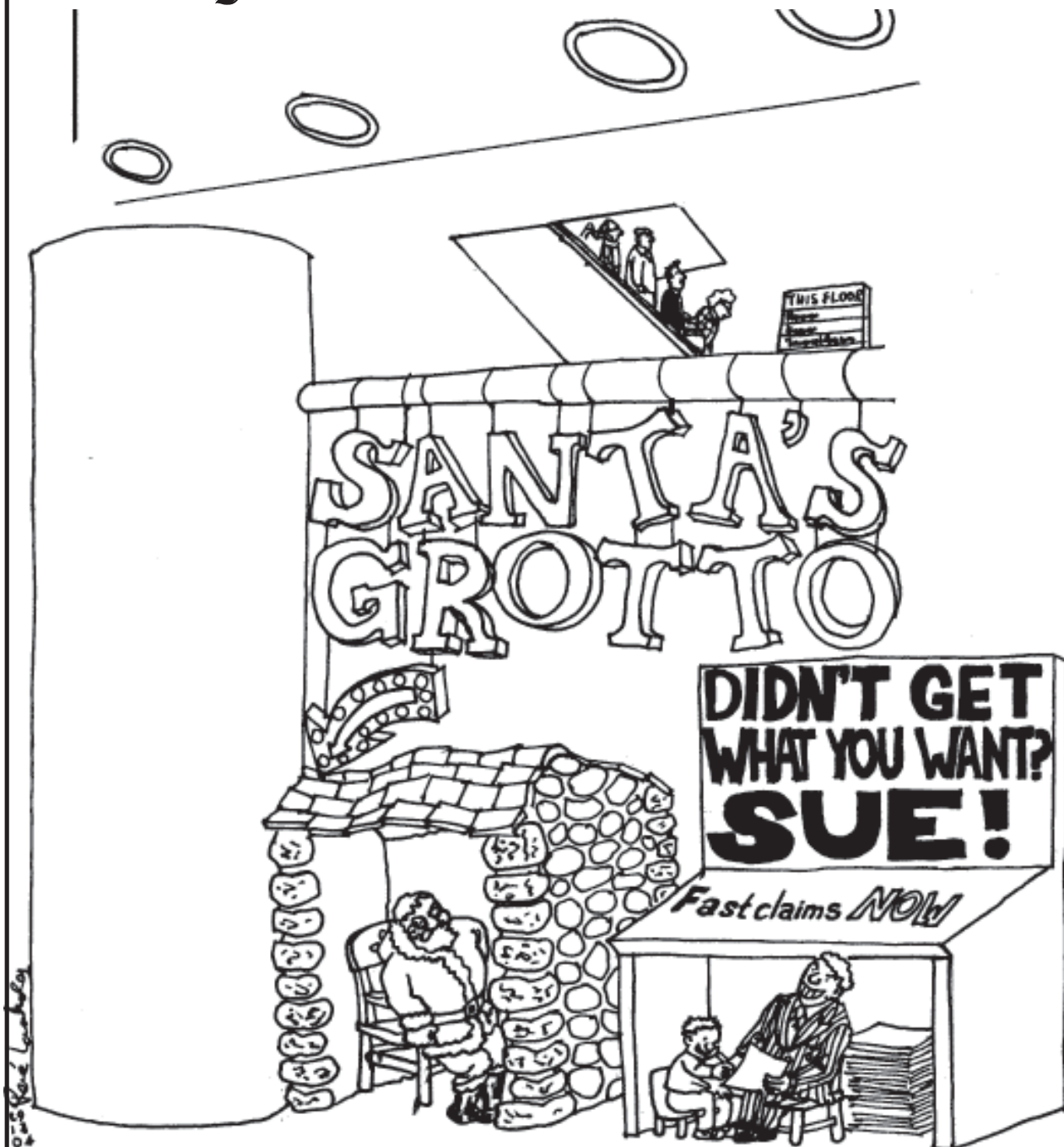
No. 3
December 2004

FREE INSIDE!

PI and UCL News
- The Executive
Summary

Just as crap as the real
thing, but they only take 5
minutes to read - pp. 4-5

Merry Christmas



THIS MONTH

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Ending Musical — p.3

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LFH? — p.8

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Correction

In our last issue (No. 2, October), we referred in the article 'Journalistic Harm-ony' to 'one of the vox pops in the *London Student* article'. This referred to a prepared interview with Danny Stone, campaigns organiser for the Union of Jewish Students, for *London Student*, and not a 'vox pop' in the accepted sense of interviewing a passer-by. In fact, I inserted the word there myself, and apologise for any misunderstanding - Ed.

Follow-Ups of Last Issue

The inevitable fallout from October...

UCL News

OCTOBER'S *The Cheese Grater* carried an article attacking UCL News for not reporting student issues and generally being a waste.

Well, the man in charge of UCL News, head of communications Nicholas Tyndale, recently defended his publication's record, albeit with qualifications. Asked if he thought if UCL's two miserable periodicals (compared to Imperial's four newspapers) were doing a satisfactory job, he said they were doing a good job for the budget provided. Come on Malcolm, hand over some cash to stop your college's attempts at media being so pathetic.

The Cover

WE ARE RELIABLY informed that *London Student* editor Alexi Duggins read the last issue. Or at least he looked at the front cover, and couldn't tell the difference between the caricatures of himself and Dex Torricke-Barton. Okay Alexi, here's some help.

You have spiky hair. Sometimes. Dex doesn't. Dex has glasses. You don't. You wear a stripy jersey on occasions. Dex, to our knowledge, doesn't.

So the non-glasses wearing, spiky-haired, stripy-jersey wearing...

The Great *London Student* Debâcle

SOME PEOPLE, even on *The Cheese Grater*'s floor of Canary Wharf, thought that the *London Student*/Fingleton/'fuck' story in the last issue was a little out of date and irrelevant. Not, it seems, to everyone.

Among the guests at November's NUS/Daily Mirror Student Media Awards were Lila Allen, last year's *LS* editor, and David Dunne, the then KCLSU president who banned the paper (*vide The Cheese Grater ad nauseam*.) If we can believe *Pi* fashion editor Tolu Doherty, writing in same, there was "a showdown of epic proportions" between the two at a panel debate. Presumably they are still mopping up the blood in the Docklands.

The Honderich Affair

KEEN-EYED READERS of November 22nd's *London Student* may have noticed a 'right to reply' letter accompanying a spoof Santa Claus feature, purporting to be from the bearded one's lawyers.

The letter's wording bears a curious resemblance to a letter from one Farrer & Co., Ted Honderich's lawyers, sent to Alexi Duggins (see last issue p.2). But surely he wouldn't dare parody such a grave legal missive?

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Scary Boots

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Attack of the Never-Ending Musical

UCL's Garage Theatre was witness to a feature-length curtain call recently...

Nikolai Morofski

HISTORY WAS MADE at the Garage Theatre on 28th November when the booked entertainment extended beyond the script's end by the longest ever recorded curtain call (in Gordon Street, anyway). Pagoda Street, a musical written and directed by Declan Ee, provided an evening packed full of love, deceit, sin and redemption mixed in with some powerfully intoxicating humour. The wit and schmaltz reached a sentimental crescendo at a beautifully acted marriage proposal scene, and the complementary CD of the music will remain a prized possession by many. The great ambition of this production was clear, and its success even more so.

Yet this was not the end! Indeed it was barely even the beginning of the end! No, a curtain call and encore continued the story for another three acts. First the actors were all presented with roses, then the numerous crew were brought out to take their applause. Act two saw Declan himself make an illustrious appearance. He

made a series of monologues about the cast, the crew, the play, the audience, the night, his friends, his parents and his cat. He then entered into a meditative speech, complete with a coastal wave soundtrack, which implored the actors to allow this moment on stage to stretch on forever. At the same time, no doubt, a few of the audience members began to wish their bladders could stretch on forever.

Act three picked up the pace a little with a few more delightful songs from the cast, sending up elements of the performance. This clever extra material would have been most welcome had it not combined with the previous act to ensure that this alcoholic hack missed his crucial post-theatre drink. *The Cheese Grater* congratulates all involved on a magnificent performance but implores the Musical Society to take action, and demand a thirty second time limit on all directorial/authorial speeches (*Some hope — Ed.*).



Hail to the Chief

MATT COOKE, newish president of the University of London Union, got a sardonic reception when he went to the LSE recently to talk about Transformation, the proposed recasting of ULU's services and building.

The students of Aldwych Poly are notoriously ungracious to students' union leaders — perhaps because they're not set on careers in banking — and this was to be no exception. One audience member asked Cooke which college of the University he hailed from. The Royal Academy of Music, he replied. "Sing us a song!" someone piped up.



THE NEW UNIVERSITY COLlege Hospital building looks set to open on schedule in April 2005, and all the services currently offered by the Middlesex Hospital will move there — presumably with its medics.

The UCLH NHS Trust website is predictably gushing about the new

UCLH bed cock-up - fit for 21st century?

building, proffering statistics galore: 97 metres high, 100 kilometres of ductwork, 2400 PCs, 3000 'vision panels'...but one figure is left out. The width between beds is just 2.7 metres, according to *Private Eye* on November 26 — less than the minimum demanded by new rules to combat the MRSA bug.

Why build a new hospital anyway? According to the website, "We do a large amount of this work in con-

ditions at The Middlesex and University College Hospitals, which are rapidly becoming unsuitable for 21st century healthcare". Presumably exposing patients — and UCL medical students — to an illegally high risk of infection is suitable, then.

Medical students and sites' officer Vishali Thakrar was unavailable for comment at the time of going to press.

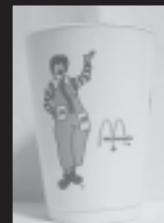
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UCLNEWS

Issue 03 Volume 02 6 December 2004

Pro-Provost's wife appears on 'Richard and Judy' 2 UCL voted 'University of the Year' by the 'Daily Mail Good Citizens' Guide' 2 PhD students sell selves to Wellcome Trust in return for a sandwich 3 Third Rawnsley Symposium fails to start 4 Survey announces dog 4 Rape 5 Sanitary towels 6 Hello is anyone reading this bit 7 God raped with mango chutney 8 Obviously not 642



Professor Grant enjoys having 'Happy Birthday' sung to him recently. One person sang 'dear Malcolm' instead of 'dear Provost', but was dealt with swiftly.

Private View

What is it?

A small plastic cup, significantly battered.

How old is it?

Experts reckon, using a new dating system, the cup could have been abandoned as long ago as last Tuesday.

Where is it?

UCL, one would hope.

How did it get there?

Mystery surrounds this issue, and theories abound: while some maintain it is clear evidence for quantum tunnelling in macroscopic objects, others insist it was dropped by a bloke.

What makes it special?

Again, there is some debate on this point – some claim to have seen an image of Jesus in the cup, whereas others say it more strongly resembles Elvis. It has also been hypothesised that the complex arrangement of creases on the side encodes a chemical formula which could halt, or at least slow, the ageing process. On the other hand it could contain nothing but coffee dregs.

What else is in the collections?

The 'Stuff Wot I found in the Cloisters' collection contains many stunning examples of rococo packaging and contemporary persuasive art; also several rare flyers and the centrepiece of the collection, an old bus ticket.

Who uses the collections?

'Uses'?

How can I view it?

Cast your eyes to the picture above, dear reader.

Provost's new moustache unveiled

New hair appendage to 'maximise global benefits to staff and students'

On December 1st, in a lavish ceremony in UCL's Old Refectory, the late Princess Margaret unveiled the new moustache of UCL Provost and President, Professor Malcolm Grant.

The moustache is just the latest in a series of innovative amen-

ties that will enhance UCL's status as a world leader. "It's over 40% bigger than my last moustache," enthused Grant, "and only costs as much as a racehorse to maintain."

UCL In The News

UCL requests £300million from its alumni

UCL asks its more famous alumni to ask the public for money

UCL asks Americans to come and help them make money

UCL professors advise that to maintain buildings will require more money

And in a striking break from tradition, the Petrie Museum receives some money, although only a puny £13.5 million.



Bentham receives even more recognition

Unsatisfied with an effigy, a cocktail, a common room, a pub, and numerous references in any literature relating to UCL, the guy who just won't die has got a plaque too.

pi magazine

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FREE

The Student Magazine of University College London Union

Coldplay “fucking tired” of being mentioned in Pi

by DIRK PLODDER

COLDPLAY, the band who formed at UCL and made it a hip and fashionable haven for all self-respecting students whose parents are investment bankers, announced yesterday after reading the Freshers' Issue of Pi that they are fed up of being mentioned in the magazine, and never want to feature in it again.

Jonny Buckland, guitarist and former resident of Ramsay Hall, said on the *Guardian* website: “We’ve had enough. We’re just fucking tired of being the only thing that can widen



UCL’s appeal beyond people too stupid for Oxbridge who can afford London bar prices. Especially when that obviously hasn’t worked.”

Fortunately, UCL’s media promoters need not worry. Pi, which used to be

Can YOU spot all the spelling mistakes in this issue of Pi??? If so, don't bother running for an editorial position!

edited by Jonathan Dimbleby by the way, can exclusively reveal that UCL alumnus Ricky Gervais, who since the success of ‘The Office’ spends his days doing circuits of Russell Square trying to get noticed, is still happy to be featured in Pi.

Meanwhile, we will try and whip up the media profile of Digby Jones (Laws 1977), the chief executive of the Confederation of British Industry, into that of a rock band. Failing that, I suppose we could try with that woman from Elastica.

Leeds students ‘anti-pencil’

by SALLY HUMPHREYS

A NEW STUDY by Leeds University has proved conclusively and for the first time ever that Leeds students don’t really use pencils any more.

The research, conducted by the university’s centre for cultural studies, has finally shattered the long-standing popular myth of the ‘pencil-using Leeds student. According to the survey, conducted over the past 20 years, less than 0.2% of the student body at Leeds admit to owning a pencil, let alone using one.

“The importance of this research simply cannot be underestimated,” a spokesman for the university said on the *Guardian* website. “There’s clearly been a watershed in student behaviour over the past two decades”.

The National Union of Students (NUS)

was quick to play up the negative side of the research. “This study shows that, without grants, few students can now afford to buy and maintain a pencil, even outside the M25,” said NUS President Kat Fletcher, herself a Leeds graduate.

Fashion

by TOBY CHISWICK

While in October the recommended haute couture outfit was a classic, yet daring combination of jeans, jacket, shoes and shirt, in either a ever-stylish combination of tonal shades or a daring thrilling contrast, this month Pi is lauding the boho chic of art students. So it seems the readership can rest assured that no matter what the wear, Pi will approve.



Pester the Provost

Pi asked MALCOLM GRANT a series of difficult, probing questions...

Q1: Provost, why are you so clever and brilliant?

Ha ha ha. Good question, thanks for asking. Well, it took years of practice. First I had to be a law professor at UCL and teach lovely students like yourselves. But some of it’s just a gift, really. I like to think of it like a sort of divine right. Anyway, I couldn’t be any worse than that tosser Roberts, could I?

Q2: Are you pleased now we’re Sunday Times University of the Year?

Oh yes, very pleased, very pleased indeed. This is a tribute to the fine academic standards...tradition of excellence...biochemistry...liberal tradition...(to be continued)



The Cheese Grater Guide to Christmas

Ah, Christmas. The whole surviving family gathers round, a dog crackling merrily on the fire, and they all get their heads cut off. Or, if a Genghis Khan Christmas isn't for you, try our tips, as suggested by Scary Boots...

Emergency Conversational Topics for Christmas Social Events

(for use with relatives, fringe acquaintances, and the Queen)

"So, [insert name], where did you get the idea for such a staggeringly unattractive and unimaginative hair-cut?"

"Nice to see you haven't changed the recipe for the cake! Oh, no, wait.. you haven't changed the cake."

"Young people today, eh?"

"What we need more of in this country are traditional family values. Traditional Family Values for Traditional Families. Don't you agree, half-

step-uncle?"

"Did anyone watch 'Celebrity Temptation to Resume Coke Habit Island'?"

"You know, I was thinking just the other day how degrees mean nothing in the real world and one can easily learn everything one requires from hands-on experience!"

"Hey, does anyone else want to play a spirit-crushing board game with mind-numbingly complicated rules that only one branch of the family knows how to play and will take gleeful delight in explaining in ever more complex ways to everyone else, who

will end up smiling bemusedly and politely and getting thrashed?"

"As a token of my appreciation this Christmas, I have decided to give you a portion of all I have. Enjoy the debt."

"Yes, my hair is silly, isn't it .. I can't wait till I no longer have any and don't have to worry."

And if entirely desperate:

"You know most murders take place at Christmas, and are committed by someone you know?"



Scary Boots

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Christmas on TV

If you've taken any of the advice opposite, it'll be time to barricade the door and settle down to some good old Christmas telly. Here's a preview and review...



Television

AA Roadmap

I was reversing the Audi out of one of those badger-cul bolt-holes in St. John's Wood — the ones that look as though they've been designed to take a tentful of Sudanese refugees and a packet of Corn Flakes, and no more — when the Bonde opened her mouth and said, "Look at the clouds; there not white, they're just a whiter shade of grey."

Well, great. And that's just what you're getting for Christmas. Once again, the Tristrums have been doing their deadly work with life-affirming

precision: "Above all, it's got to be Christmassy."

I despair, I really do. Saying television at Christmas should be Christmassy is like being sodomised by a humpback whale and telling it to make it painful. It goes so stupidly to the point that it never gets there at all, and hangs around pointlessly, like Sartre on an oil drum in Paris in '68. What you must understand about Sartre is, he had a lumpy old orange for a head. He actually had a lumpy old orange for a head. I mean, why didn't Michel Foucault go up to him and tell him: "Monsieur Sartre, je regrette d'annoncer que vous avez une vieille orange pour une tête"? Ah, but it would have brightened things up a little.

Anyway, I suppose the lovely people at Times House want me to write something about this godforsaken sop to a decadent walrus' family, so here it is. Judi Dench is thoroughly



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unwatchable; you're better off with Del Boy. There, I've said it. Now leave me alone. I'm not writing about TV again till next Christmas.



PICK OF THE DAY

Pride and Prejudice (BBC1, 18:30): a sub-standard reworking of *Pride and Prejudice*TM; in this episode Lizzy BennetTM spurns the advances of Mr DarcyTM. How will Mr DarcyTM react? Will Lydia BennetTM run off with

the evil Mr. WickhamTM? Brand-new drama sponsored by MattellTM.

Donnie Darko (C4, 22:55): mind-bending film. Warning; features strong language, sentiments of a depressing nature, scenes of mild violence towards a statue, one scene of strong peril, references of a sexual nature, 6ft grey-coloured bunny rabbit, 6ft orange-coloured Patrick Swayze, accusations that Patrick Swayze's character is a paedophile (his lawyers wish to state that Patrick

Swayze is NOT, I repeat, NOT a real-life paedophile and is in fact a

patron of a children's charity), controversial speculation about the sexual practices of Smurfs/Smurfettes, deeply unsatisfying ending. People of a nervous disposition or a tendency to think suicidal thoughts, lovers of sculpture, prudes and insomniacs may wish to reconsider viewing this film.

Griff Rhys Jones to buy London Foot Hospital?



N O , WE'RE NOT making it up. The long-haired multi-millionaire TV producer, actor and presenter of BBC's *Restoration* programme might possibly try to bring the London Foot Hospital back to life.

The LFH, based in Fitzrovia, was once site to UCL's now-defunct podiatry course. After a futile campaign last year to save the hospital, the building looks set to be sold off to some developer. However, sources close to Jones, who made £23 million when he sold his stake in nearby-based TV production company Talkback Thames 2000, tell us that he has recently considered forming a consortium to buy up and preserve the hospital. So far, however, no serious buyers appear to have come forward. RL

The hirsute TV man, inset, and the London Foot Hospital in Fitzroy Square, up for grabs.

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What? Is that it?

Yes.

No other stuff?

No no more.

Why not?

Nobody did any. Besides, it's nearly Christmas; give your eyes a rest.

Bollocks to that. What about more stuff?

Good idea. Why don't you contribute?

How?

Write, draw or photo graph stuff. But there's another way to contribute. You can tell us of any stories you think should be investigated by e-mailing us at: cheese_grater_magazine_society@ucl.ac.uk

Why should I, anyway?

We've got a lot going for us. We didn't get disaffiliated, for a start. And we're not about to disappear. This issue has appeared in a bigger number than last time, more people have heard of it, and it's getting to a wider audience. Your efforts will be noticed. And next year, we expect to have a website too. You've got to at least acknowledge we're here.

When's next issue?

Sometime in February. Then there'll be a final issue for the year. Oh, and there'll be the AGM, so if you want to take over as editor...well, you can try.

Now what do I do?

Stop reading.

Contributors to this issue: Nikolai Morofski, Scary Boots, Amy Leung **Thanks:** Tom Jenkins, Prof. John Foreman

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The views expressed herein are not necessarily those of UCL Union. In fact, they're probably not.